

Categorization of Assessment Units based on the 'Stage of Ground Water Extraction'

S. No	Category	GWRA-2017		GWRA-2020		GWRA-2022		GWRA-2023		GWRA-2024		GWRA-2025	
		Number of AUs	% of AUs	Number of AUs	% of AUs	Number of AUs	% of AUs	Number of AUs	% of AUs	Number of AUs	% of AUs	Number of AUs	% of AUs
1	Safe	2	50	2	50	2	50	3	37.50	3	37.50	3	37.50
2	Semi-critical							3	37.50	3	37.50	3	37.50
3	Critical			1	25	1	25						
4	Over-exploited	1	25					1	12.50	1	12.50	1	12.50
5	Saline	1	25	1	25	1	25	1	12.50	1	12.50	1	12.50
Total number of AUs		4		4		4		8		8		8	

Recommendations: -

- * The Union Territory of Puducherry is underlain by the semi-consolidated and unconsolidated sedimentary formations, which mainly sustain dug wells, shallow and deep tube wells. The yield of the wells generally varies between 3 to 15 Litres per second. High yielding wells in the range of 10 to 40 lps exists in the Tertiary sand-stones. The Dynamic ground water resources for Union Territory of Puducherry have been assessed Taluk wise.
- * The Annual Ground Water Recharge of the UT of Puducherry has been assessed as 0.19 bcm, Annual Extractable Ground Water Resources is 0.17 bcm and the Annual Ground Water Extraction is 0.13 bcm. The overall Stage of Ground Water Extraction of Union Territory of Puducherry is 75.98 %.
- * Out of 8 assessment units, 3 units (37.5%) (Mahe, Karaikal & Thirunallar) have been categorized as 'Safe', 3 units (37.50%) (Ozhukarai, Villianur & Bahour) as 'Semi-Critical', 1 unit (12.50%) (Puducherry) as 'Over-exploited' and 1 unit (12.50%) (Yanam) as 'Saline'.
- * In the safe category areas of Puducherry, State Government can judiciously develop the ground water resource mainly for agricultural use, however, at no point of time the extraction level should exceed 70%.
- * In the critical category areas of Puducherry, Rooftop Rainwater Harvesting may be adopted.
- * Ground Water Year Book published by CGWB having water level & water quality data may be used in Ground water management. (<https://cgwb.gov.in/cgwbpm/>).
- * Regulation & control of Ground water Extraction: Ministry of Jal Shakti has issued the guidelines for control and regulations of ground water extraction vide notification dated 24.09.2020 which has further been amended in March 2023. Concerned departments may ensure implementations of the guidelines.

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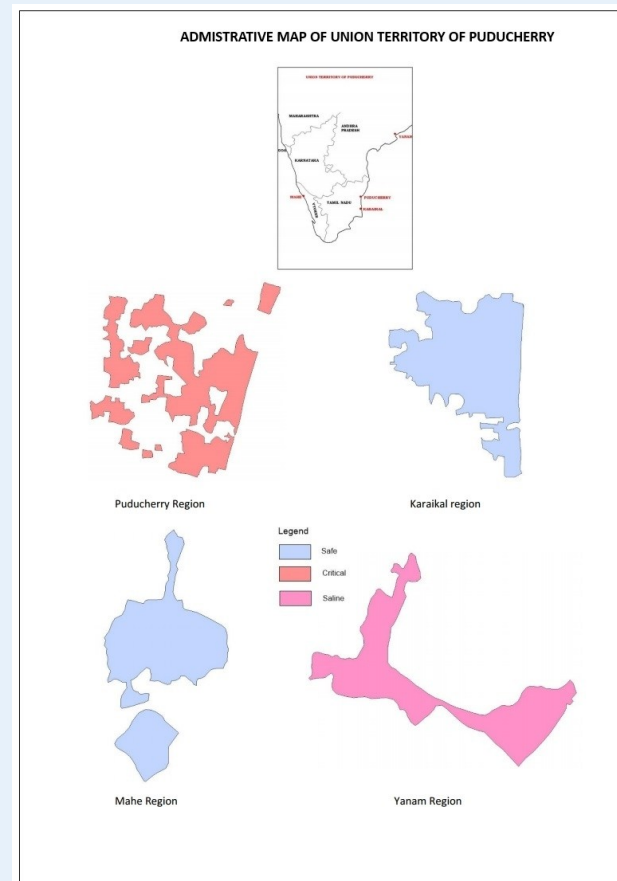
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Central Ground Water Board Department of Water Resources, RD & GR Ministry of Jal Shakti, Government of India



Dynamic Ground Water Resources, 2025 Puducherry

November, 2025

Background

- ◆ Ground Water Resources Assessment (GWRA)- jointly carried out by Central Ground Water Board and State Nodal/Ground Water Department periodically as per the Ground Water Resource Estimation Committee (GEC) methodology.
- ◆ Carried out under the guidance of the respective State/UT Level Committees (SLCs) and overall supervision of Central Level Expert Group (CLEG).
- ◆ As part of the assessment, 'Annual Extractable Ground Water Resource' as well as 'Annual Ground Water Extraction' are assessed for each assessment unit (Taluk).
- ◆ The 'Stage of Ground Water Extraction' is computed as the ratio of 'Annual Ground Water Extraction' with respect to 'Annual Extractable Ground Water Resource' and is usually expressed in percentage. Based on the stage of extraction, the assessment units are categorized as Safe ($\leq 70\%$), Semi-Critical ($>70\%$ and $\leq 90\%$), Critical ($>90\%$ and $\leq 100\%$) and Over-Exploited ($>100\%$).
- ◆ GWRA- 2025, 2024, 2023, 2022 and 2020 has been carried out through a software/web-based application "INDIA-GROUNDWATER RESOURCE ESTIMATION SYSTEM (IN-GRES)" developed by CGWB through IIT-Hyderabad.

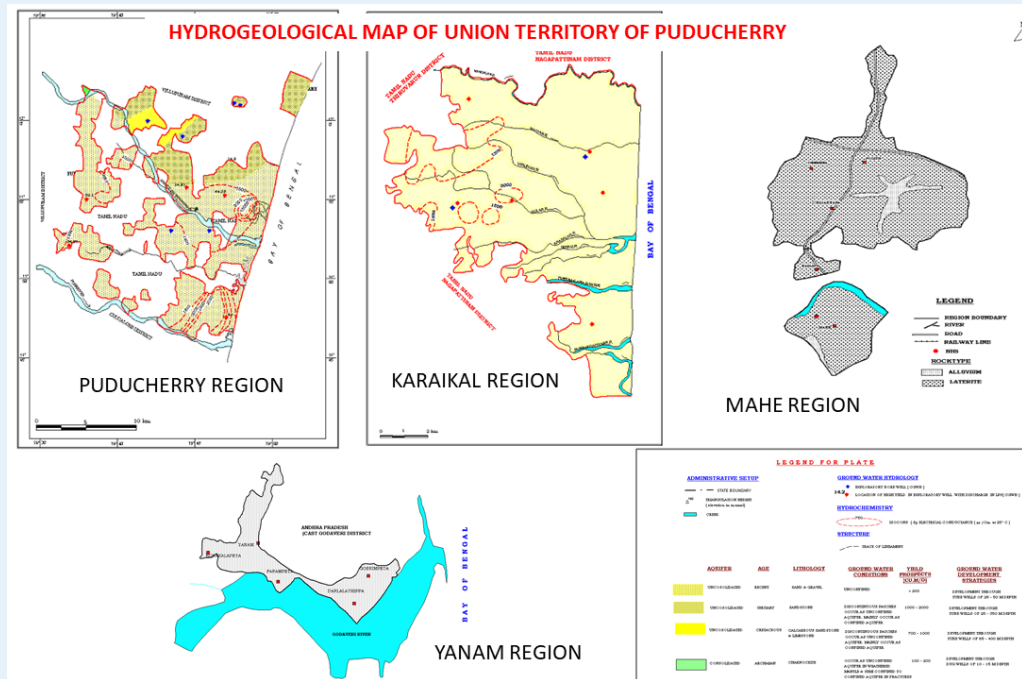
Salient Features

1	Rainfall	1,247.39 mm
2	Hydrogeology	Area is underlain by the semi-consolidated and unconsolidated sedimentary formations.
3	Recharge Worthy Area of the State	483 Sq. Km
4	Assessment Unit (AU) Type / Number	Taluk / 8 Numbers
5	Average area of Assessment Unit	60.38 Sq. Km

Findings

	Attribute	GWRA-2017	GWRA-2020	GWRA-2022	GWRA-2023	GWRA-2024	GWRA-2025
1	Total Annual Ground Water Recharge (in bcm)	0.23	0.22	0.21	0.20	0.19	0.19
2	Annual Extractable Ground Water Resources (in bcm)	0.2	0.2	0.19	0.18	0.17	0.17
3	Annual Ground Water Extraction (in bcm)	0.15	0.15	0.13	0.13	0.13	0.13
4	Stage of Ground Water Extraction (in %)	74.33	74.27	69.17	70.27	75.91	75.98

bcm: Biliion Cubic Meters



CATEGORIZATION MAP OF PUDUCHERRY

